

Correction (See disclosures for details)

Standard Chartered Plc (HK) (2888)

4Q25 mixed, but updated FY26 guidance is likely to push for PPoP upgrades

Our Take: STAN 4Q results are mixed, but FY26 guidance beats expectations. 4Q revenue is largely in line with NII beats, but non-NII missed on lower episodic income from Global Markets. But clean PBT is 6% lower as cost is 4% higher than consensus. DPS is 40% higher than consensus and the \$1.5bn buyback is in line with expectations. However, we believe market focus will center on FY26 guidance, which beat expectations. We welcome the move to statutory ROTE now expected at >12% for 2026 and ahead of consensus at 11.7%, and trending up from 2025 (11.9%). The Group expects total income growth at the bottom end of the 5-7% range on a c\$20.9bn revenue base in 2025, implying 2% upside to consensus. The Group also expects higher underlying cost but lower Fit-for-growth cost, resulting in flat reported costs y/y at c\$13.3bn, broadly in line with consensus including exceptional costs). We expect updated guidance to drive mid-single digit upward revisions to consensus 26E PPoP. We expect statutory ROTE to trend up towards ~14.5% by 2028. STAN remains a top pick, trading at 10.0x P/E, 1.1x PB for an Adj ROE of 11.6% in 26E. Maintain OW.

- **What we like:** 1) NII of \$2.95bn was 8% above consensus and +8% q/q, driven by a temporary improvement in CASA passthroughs with HIBOR +86bps in 4Q, and a timing benefit in treasury income. AIEAs were flat q/q with underlying loans +1% q/q driven by CIB loans +\$2bn q/q, while WRB loans were flat q/q, and underlying deposits were +1% q/q driven by WRB (+\$6bn) partly offset by CIB deposits (-\$2bn q/q). 2) Credit impairments of \$145m (14bps CoR) were below consensus of \$228m. 3) DPS of \$0.49 was c40% ahead of consensus of \$0.35.
- **What is in line:** 1) CET1 of 14.1% was in line with RWAs 1% below consensus. SBBs of \$1.5bn were ahead of consensus of \$1.39bn. 2) TNAV/sh was \$17.30 vs consensus of \$17.35.
- **What we don't like:** 1) Other income of \$1.90bn was 11% below consensus mainly driven by lower episodic income in Global Markets due to the timing of large client deals and market volatility impacting inventory held for client activity. Total income was \$4.85bn and 1% below consensus. 2) Costs of \$3.43bn were 4% above consensus and included \$121mn impact from the effect of higher share price on stock awards and one-off regulatory changes, driving PPOP of \$1.42bn, 11% below consensus. 3) Underlying PBT of \$1.31bn is 6% below consensus, while Reported PBT of \$0.81bn was 23% below consensus, led by higher restructuring and other items vs consensus.

See page 6 for analyst certification and important disclosures, including non-US analyst disclosures.

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Overweight

2888.HK, 2888 HK

Price: HK\$192.00

23 Feb 2026

Price Target: HK\$265.00

PT End Date: 31 Dec 2026

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- **Outlook & Guidance beat expectations:** Management notes that 1Q has started strong across the business. New guidance provided on a statutory basis vs underlying previously. **2026: 1)** New 2026 statutory RoTE guidance of >12% (consensus 11.7%, 2025 11.9%). **2)** Reported income growth to be around the bottom end of 5-7% (const-fx, ex notables), implying 2026E revenues of \$21.9bn (c2% above consensus at \$21.5bn), with NII flat at c\$11.2bn, which implies non-NII growth of c11% y/y. **3)** Reported costs to be broadly flat y/y (const-fx, ex notables) implying 2026E costs of \$13.3bn (in line with consensus at \$13.23bn). **4)** Fit-for-growth (FFG) restructuring costs and gross cost saves (both included in reported cost guidance) to be \$1.3bn (vs \$1.5bn before). FFG will end in 2026 (as guided) with zero restructuring costs in 2027. Ventures segment will now be reported across WRB (Digital Banks) and Central (SCV). Medium-term targets to be provided in May'26.
- **Performance by key product segments (const-FX) in 4Q:** Global Markets -15% y/y (17% below consensus) with Macro -24% y/y and Credit flat y/y; Global Markets Flow income (+9% y/y) more than offset by negative episodic income (-\$16m in Q4 25 vs \$154m in Q4 24). Global Banking +7% y/y (1% below consensus) with Lending & Fin Solutions +9% y/y and Capital Markets & Advisory -5% y/y. Wealth +20% y/y (2% below consensus) with \$10bn net new money (\$52bn in 2025 equivalent to 14% growth of AUM, compared to c\$200bn 5Y target from 2025) and c75k new-to-bank affluent clients onboarded (c275k in 2025 and consistently >60k clients per quarter).
- **Hong Kong business review.** Growth rates on HK revenue and PPOP in 4Q25 were +19%/+55% y/y, respectively, reversing from -1%/-12% y/y contraction in 3Q25. The business delivered positive jaws with expense contracting by 5% y/y with income growth of +19% y/y, bringing CIR down 12.2pcts y/y to 48.2% in 4Q25. 4Q profits increased 128% y/y, supported by lowered loan impairment charges (-83% y/y), therefore, credit cost on an annualized basis edged down -36bps y/y to 7bps in 4Q. Loans contracted -2% q/q (+4% y/y), ahead of Group loan trends (+2% y/y), while deposits remained flat at 0% q/q (or +13% y/y).
- **HK CRE – reduced exposure and decrease in stage 2 ratio:** In 4Q25, HK CRE exposure declined by 17% q/q to US\$1.5bn due to repayment, and accounted for 0.5% of total loan book, edging down from 0.6% in 3Q25. 94% of the exposures are performing, and the stage 2 loans ratio edged down by 10pcts q/q to 32% in 4Q. Stage 3 loan ratio increased by 1pcts q/q to 6%, due to decline in total balance, while there is no change to Stage 3 exposures. We note that 86% of exposure are secured (vs 89% in 3Q25) with average LTV <50%. Management has reduced the overlay by \$13mn q/q to \$47mn, due to repayments and upgrades.

- **Likely changes to consensus:** We expect mid-single-digit upside to consensus PPOP forecasts for 26E driven by stronger revenues with consensus stated costs in line. We see the potential for upgrades to consensus 2027 PPOP on continued revenue growth, although partly offset by investments and inflation.
- **HK peer read-across – positive:** We see these results as a positive read-across for HSBC's Wealth revenues with StanChart Wealth income growth of +20% y/y in 4Q alongside net new money of \$10bn (inc. \$6bn in Wealth) at c9% inflow rate in 4Q, and a strong outlook for non-NII growth of c11% y/y in 2026E.
- **Stock price reaction:** We expect the stock to trade up post 4Q25 results.
- **Conference call details:** 08:00 UK/ 16:00 HK on Tuesday, 24 February 2026. You will be able to access the presentation via [webcast link](#) here.

Table 1: StanChart 4Q25 results summary

	4Q24	3Q25	4Q25E	4Q25 Cons	4Q25A	A vs Cons.	A vs JPMe	Y/Y	Q/Q
NII	2,977	2,737	2,771	2,742	2,949	8%	6%	-1%	8%
Other Income	1,832	2,410	2,045	2,142	1,899	-11%	-7%	4%	-21%
Revenue	4,809	5,147	4,816	4,884	4,848	-1%	1%	1%	-6%
o.w. Transaction Services	1,666	1,488	1,462	1,485	1,521	2%	4%	-9%	2%
o.w. Global Banking	500	588	558	549	545	-1%	-2%	9%	-7%
o.w. Global Markets	773	848	796	791	660	-17%	-17%	-15%	-22%
o.w. Wealth Solutions	562	890	686	689	677	-2%	-1%	20%	-24%
Operating expenses	-3,277	-2,953	-3,326	-3,286	-3,429	4%	3%	5%	16%
Pre-provision operating profit	1,532	2,194	1,491	1,598	1,419	-11%	-5%	-7%	-35%
Loan impairments	-130	-195	-212	-228	-145	-36%	-32%	12%	-26%
Profits pre-Other impairments/Assocs	1,402	1,999	1,279	1,370	1,274	-7%	0%	-9%	-36%
Other impairments	-353	-20	-4	-47	-13	-72%	225%	-96%	-35%
Profit from associates	-27	6	8	-9	-26	189%	-425%	-4%	-533%
Clean Pretax profits	1,022	1,985	1,283	1,314	1,235	-6%	-4%	21%	-38%
Total one-offs	-222	-219	-342	-257	-421	64%	23%	90%	92%
Pretax profits	800	1,766	941	1,057	814	-23%	-13%	2%	-54%
DPS	0.28	-	0.34	0.35	0.49	41%	43%	75%	-
Underlying RoTE	8.1%	13.4%	8.0%	8.5%	9.6%				
TNAV/s	\$15.41	\$16.84	\$17.30	\$17.35	\$17.30	0%	0%	12%	3%
CET1 ratio	14.2%	14.2%	14.0%	14.1%	14.1%				
RWAs	247	258	262	261	258	-1%	-1%	4%	0%
Loans (amortised cost)	281	285	288	288	287	0%	0%	2%	1%
Customer deposits	464	526	528	516	530	3%	0%	14%	1%
SBB	1500	-	1500	1390	1500	8%	0%	0%	-

Source: J.P. Morgan estimates, Company data.

Table 2: StanChart 4Q25 product revenue

US\$ mn	4Q24	3Q25	4Q25E	4Q25 Cons	4Q25A	A vs Cons.	A vs JPMe	Y/Y	Q/Q
Transaction Services	1,666	1,488	1,462	1,485	1,521	2%	4%	-9%	2%
Payments and Liquidity	1,193	1,016	1,008	1,017	1,065	5%	6%	-11%	5%
Securities Services	161	166	167	164	173	5%	4%	7%	4%
Trade & Working Capital	312	306	287	304	283	-7%	-1%	-9%	-8%
Banking	500	588	558	549	545	-1%	-2%	9%	-7%
Lending & Financial Solutions	434	496	488	474	481	1%	-1%	11%	-3%
Capital Market & Advisory	66	92	70	75	64	-15%	-9%	-3%	-30%
Markets	773	848	796	791	660	-17%	-17%	-15%	-22%
Macro Trading	654	678	634	642	499	-22%	-21%	-24%	-26%
Credit Trading	138	206	158	157	138	-12%	-13%	0%	-33%
Valuation & Other Adj	(19)	(36)	4	(5)	23				
Wealth Solutions	562	890	686	689	677	-2%	-1%	20%	-24%
Investment Products	452	691	572	553	553	0%	-3%	22%	-20%
Bancassurance	110	199	114	122	124	2%	8%	13%	-38%
CCPL & Other Unsecured Lending	270	277	262	271	264	-3%	1%	-2%	-5%
Deposits & Mortgages	1,058	1,034	1,015	1,041	1,050	1%	3%	-1%	2%
Ventures	60	39	52	54	56	4%	8%	-7%	44%
Digital Banks	41	49	52	51	58		-	-	-
SCV	19	(10)	0	4	(2)		-	-	-
Treasury & Other	(80)	(17)	(15)	(6)	75		-	-	-
Total underlying operating income	4,809	5,147	4,816	4,874	4,848				

Source: J.P. Morgan estimates, Company data.

Table 3: 4Q25 Hong Kong business results

Hong Kong (US\$ mn)	4Q24A	3Q25A	4Q25A	Q/Q	Y/Y
Operating income	1,137	1,220	1,352	11%	19%
Operating expenses	(686)	(618)	(651)	5%	-5%
PPoP	451	602	701	16%	55%
Loan impairment	(92)	(69)	(16)	-77%	-83%
Other impairment	(58)	(1)	0	-100%	-100%
Associates and JV	0	0	0	NA	NA
Underlying PBT	301	532	685	29%	128%
Total Assets	193,212	210,684	217,291	3%	12%
Customer loans	86,034	91,282	89,641	-2%	4%
Customer deposits	166,420	187,204	187,753	0%	13%
Average customer loans	85,955	88,711	90,462	2%	5%
Credit Costs	0.43%	0.31%	0.07%	-24 bps	-36 bps
Cost/ income ratio	60%	51%	48%	-250 bps	-1218 bps
Loan to deposit ratio	52%	49%	48%	-102 bps	-395 bps

Source: J.P. Morgan, Company data.

Table 4: StanChart HK CRE exposure summary

In US\$ mn	3Q24	4Q24	1Q25	2Q25	3Q25	4Q25
HK CRE exposure	2,300	2,600	2,200	2,100	1,800	1,500
Stage 1 ratio	NA	79%	64%	65%	53%	62%
Stage 2 ratio	NA	21%	34%	31%	42%	32%
Stage 3 ratio	0%	0%	2%	4%	5%	6%
HK CRE exposure as % of total	0.8%	0.9%	0.8%	0.7%	0.6%	0.5%
Provisions	34	58	82	116	134	NA
NPL coverage ratio	NA	NA	186%	138%	149%	NA
LLR / Loans	1.5%	2.2%	3.7%	5.5%	7.4%	NA
Unsecured %	14%	18%	17%	19%	11%	14%
Secured %	86%	82%	83%	81%	89%	86%
Average LTV of secured loans	<40%	<40%	~40%	<50%	<50%	<50%

Source: Company data.

Investment Thesis

We see StanChart as undervalued relative to its sector/EM peers at 1.1x PTNAV with significant earnings growth potential supported by structural growth drivers and relatively high capital return. We expect a ~7% revenue CAGR over '23-26E, driven by non-NII led by Wealth and Financial Markets, with the group's previous investments producing revenue momentum. NII is likely to be under pressure in '25-26E owing to lower rates, although this would be partly offset by volume growth, increased structural hedging and assertively managed deposits pass-through. We estimate a ~4% cost CAGR with the group's restructuring program likely to drive material cost saves by FY26, supporting a PPOP CAGR of 12% and RoTE reaching 13.8%/13.5% in FY25E/26E. Capital remains strong; we forecast distributions of ~\$10.9bn compared to group targets of >\$8bn in '24-26E and expect a further \$1.5bn of share buybacks to be announced with FY25 results. CRE remains a risk, although we see the group as better positioned compared to peers and pro-actively managing higher-risk exposures lower. Maintain OW.

Valuation

Our Dec-26 PT of HK\$265 is derived from our DDM analysis with NAV discounted back to Dec-26 from FY28E and a fair P/B of 1.5x. Our key assumptions are a normalized ROE of 11.8% and a cost of capital of 9.3%.

Risks to Rating and Price Target

The key downside risks to our rating and price target include:

- **Macroeconomic risks:** Being an EM-focused bank, StanChart is exposed to general macroeconomic risk in EM such as slowdowns, inflationary pressures, depreciation of EM currencies and cross-border and political risks. Potential weakness in China macro and regional sovereign continue to be risks towards revenues and impairments in the near term, as well as geopolitical tensions creating a potential headwind.
- **Provisioning outlook:** We expect provisions to grow to above normalized levels by 2025 given growing pressures in the economic environment. An increase or decrease in provisions as a result of the economic outlook or with regards to specific cases poses a risk to our forecasts.
- **Regulatory uncertainty:** Standard Chartered remains exposed to the changes in the regulatory environment in the UK with capital requirements being set by the PRA in the UK. While StanChart has limited UK exposure, the group is still subject to regulatory changes such as Basel 4 and BoE stress tests.

Correction: Updated to reflect the restatement of 4Q24 numbers in Table 3 and to correct the related discussion in the “Hong Kong business review” bullet on page 2.

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Standard Chartered Plc (HK) (2888) (2888.HK, 2888 HK) Price Chart



Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P. and J.P. Morgan; price data adjusted for stock splits and dividends.
Initiated coverage Sep 24, 2002. All share prices are as of market close on the previous business day.

Date	Rating	Price (HK\$)	Price Target (HK\$)
28-Feb-23	OW	72.50	85
18-Apr-23	OW	63.05	78
28-Apr-23	OW	61.95	80
07-Jul-23	OW	66.55	83
01-Aug-23	OW	74.25	90
07-Sep-23	OW	69.20	91
27-Oct-23	OW	59.75	83
16-Jan-24	OW	61.55	79
18-Jan-24	OW	57.35	78
28-Feb-24	OW	63.35	80
10-Apr-24	OW	68.25	82
03-May-24	OW	71.95	86
31-Jul-24	OW	76.90	94
04-Dec-24	OW	96.80	112
17-Feb-25	OW	108.20	120
24-Feb-25	OW	116.00	135
22-Jul-25	OW	141.30	148
04-Aug-25	OW	141.30	162
19-Oct-25	OW	142.00	168
03-Nov-25	OW	157.80	190
05-Feb-26	OW	203.40	265

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